

Expense Reimbursement Policy

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1. Overview

This article describes how employees claim reimbursement for pre-approved business expenses, including travel, client entertainment, and the remote-work home office stipend.

2. Eligible Expenses

Eligible categories are: travel (flights, trains, mileage), lodging, client meals and entertainment, professional development (courses, conference tickets), and the one-time home office stipend described in the Remote Work Policy. Personal expenses, commuting costs, and alcohol at client meals are not eligible.

3. Submission Process & Deadlines

Claims are submitted through the Expenses tab of the HR portal, referencing the internal cost center code and with original receipts attached. **Claims must be filed within 30 days of the expense date;** claims filed later are rejected automatically by the system and require a manual exception request to Finance.

4. Approval Thresholds

Claim Amount	Approval Required
Up to \$200	Auto-approved, manager notified
\$200.01 - \$500	Direct manager approval
\$500.01 - \$2,000	Direct manager + department head approval
Above \$2,000	Department head + Finance approval

5. Travel Expense Rules

Domestic flights must be booked in economy class unless the flight duration exceeds 6 hours, in which case premium economy is permitted. Mileage for personal vehicle use is reimbursed at the standard rate published quarterly on the Finance intranet page.

6. Frequently Asked Questions

- **Can I expense a client dinner including alcohol?** No, alcohol is excluded from reimbursable client entertainment expenses.
- **What if I lose a receipt?** A signed statement explaining the expense may be submitted instead for claims under \$50; above that, Finance may reject the claim.

- **How long does reimbursement take once approved?** Approved claims are paid out in the next payroll cycle, typically within 10 business days.

7. Escalation

Claims rejected for missing the 30-day deadline may be escalated to Finance via a manual exception request, which requires a written justification from the employee's manager.

Cross-Article References

- See **Remote Work Policy** for the home office stipend this policy's claims process applies to.
- See **Code of Conduct Policy** for expense-related conflict-of-interest rules.